

Exercise (Very similar to a question in HOTS): I flip two coins hidden from your view.

Version One: You ask, "Is at least one of the coins heads?" I respond, "Yes."

What is the probability they are both heads (from your perspective)?

Version Two: I say "At least one is heads." What is the probability they are both heads (from your perspective)?

Version Three: You happen to see one of the coins, and notice that it is heads.

What is the probability they are both heads (from your perspective)?

Version One:

$A = \{ \text{at least one head} \}$

$B = \{ \text{both heads} \}$

$$P(B|A) = \frac{P(A \cap B)}{P(A)} \quad \text{Rule for Cond. Prob.}$$

$$= \frac{P(B)}{P(A)}$$

$$= \frac{1/4}{1 - 1/4} = 1/3$$

HH	HT
TH	TT

Version Two: Here I have to ask myself
 (as the person judging the prob): How
 did the individual who flipped the coins
 decide what info. to provide?

A reasonable model for the info provided
 is as follows:

<u>Result</u>	<u>Info</u>
HH	"at least one heads"
HT	{ "at least one head" or "at least one tail" w.p $\frac{1}{2}$
TH	
TT	"at least one tails"

Let $A = \{ \text{info. provided "at least one heads"} \}$
 $B = \{ \text{both heads} \}$

$$P(B|A) = \frac{P(B)}{P(A)}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 P(A) &= P(A|HH)P(HH) + P(A|HT)P(HT) + \\
 &\quad P(A|TH)P(TH) + P(A|TT)P(TT) \\
 &= (1)\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) + \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) + \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) + (0)\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) = \frac{1}{2}
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{So, } P(B|A) = \frac{1/4}{1/2} = \frac{1}{2}$$

Exercise (From HOTS): This is one version of the famous “Let’s Make a Deal” or “Monty Hall” game show problem. There are three doors. You know that there is a prize behind one of them, and nothing behind the other two. The game show host tells you that you shall receive whatever is behind the door of your choice. However, before you choose, he promises that rather than immediately opening the door of your choice to reveal its contents, he will open one of the other two doors to reveal that it is empty. He will then give you the option to switch your choice. You may assume that the host is totally impartial – not malicious in any way.

You choose Door 3. He opens Door 2 and reveals that it is empty. You now know that the prize lies behind either Door 3 or Door 1. Should you switch your choice to Door 1?

$$B_i = \{ \text{prize is behind door } i \}$$

$$H_i = \{ \text{host opens door } i \}$$

$$P(B_1 | H_2) = \text{prob. win if switch}$$

$$P(B_3 | H_2) = \text{prob. win if don't switch} = \frac{1}{3}$$

$$P(B_1 | H_2) = \frac{P(H_2 | B_1) P(B_1)}{P(H_2 | B_1) P(B_1) + P(H_2 | B_2) P(B_2) + P(H_2 | B_3) P(B_3)}$$

$$= \frac{(1) \left(\frac{1}{3}\right)}{(1) \left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + (0) \left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + \left(\frac{1}{2}\right) \left(\frac{1}{3}\right)} = \frac{2}{3}$$

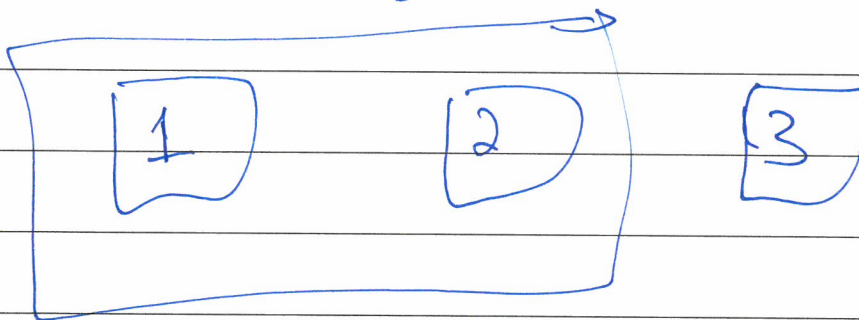
More heuristic:

Suppose instead at the outset the host two choices

(1) You can choose one door

(2) You can choose two doors

When you commit to switching, then you are "choosing" two doors



Parade Picks

Edited by Vi-An Nguyen / LIKE US AT [FACEBOOK.COM/PARADEMAG](https://www.facebook.com/parademag)

IDAHO
Forest and
conservation
technicians

NEW JERSEY
Marriage and
family
therapists

**THE MOST
POPULAR JOB
IN EVERY
STATE**

HAWAII
Dancers

TENNESSEE
Nuclear
Technicians

These four states are hotspots for the occupations above, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics*. You'll never guess which job is unusually popular in Alaska! Check out a chart of all 50 states' top jobs at parade.com/labor.

*The jobs have the highest relative concentration in their respective states.

For National Preparedness Month, America's favorite heroic dog is teaming up with Save the Children to spread the word about the importance of emergency kits for kids. From medical info to recent photos, learn what should go in every kit—and see how Lassie saves the day when she drops by the *Parade* offices—at parade.com/lassie.

**LASSIE TO
THE RESCUE**

CLASH OF THE TITANS

As the NFL season kicks off this week, we asked the sportscasters of NBC's *Sunday Night Football* and *Football Night in America* which big games they're most excited to watch. Share yours at parade.com/NFL.



AL MICHAELS and CRIS COLLINSWORTH: San Francisco at Denver (Oct. 19) "This is a possible Super Bowl preview," Michaels says. "These are two of last year's best teams, with star QBs—one at the end of a great career [Peyton Manning] and one at the start [Colin Kaepernick]," Collinsworth adds.



BOB COSTAS: Chicago at Green Bay (Nov. 9) "All of the matchups look good. But the Bears and the Packers are the most-played rivalry in the league," Costas says.



MICHELE TAFOYA and HINES WARD: Seattle at San Francisco (Thanksgiving) "Hands down, it's the NFC Championship Game rematch—a fierce rivalry with exciting quarterbacks and loads of fascinating personalities," Tafoya says. "These teams have genuine dislike but the utmost respect for each other," Ward says.



Ask Marilyn

By Marilyn vos Savant

Say that 1 million scratch-off cards are sold. Under the silver-coated area, one card reads, "You win a date with the man or woman of your dreams." All the other cards read, "You lose." After buying a card for myself, I observe 999,998 other contestants scratch off their cards to read, "You lose."

Words We Need

izzat (interjection)
reflexive comment made upon spotting a celebrity

A 999,999th contestant, his unscratched card still in his back pocket, is playing Frisbee with his dog. Should I offer him a lot of money to swap scratch-off cards with me?
—B. H., San Jose, California
No, because your chance of winning (now 50-50) wouldn't improve. Instead, offer him a lot of money to sell his card to you.

Numbrix

Complete 1 to 81 so the numbers follow a horizontal or vertical path—no diagonals.

3	5	43	49	51
9				77
11				75
21				69
29	31	33	63	67

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Exercise: It is difficult to conduct sample surveys on sensitive issues because many people will not answer questions if the answers might be embarrassing or incriminating. *Randomized Response* is an effective way to guarantee anonymity while collecting information on topics such as student cheating or tax evasion. (Warner, *Journal of the American Statistical Association*, 1965).

For example, to ask a sample of students whether they have ever used illegal drugs, have each student toss a fair coin *in private*. If the coin lands **Heads**, they are to tell the **truth**. If the coin lands **Tails** they are to answer **“Yes”** (regardless of the truth). Only the student knows whether the “embarrassing” answer (“Yes”) reflects the truth or just the coin toss.

Explain how the randomized response method can be used to estimate the probability that a student has used illegal drugs.

Part 1: Basic Discrete Probability

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1 Independent Events

- 2 A pair of events A, B are defined to be **independent** if $P(A \cap B) = P(A)P(B)$.

$$P(A|B) = P(A) \quad P(B|A) = P(B)$$

A sequence of events $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$ are independent if for **every** collection of indices

$$\{i_1, i_2, \dots, i_k\} \subseteq \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$$

for $k \leq n$ it holds that

$$P(A_{i_1} \cap A_{i_2} \cap \dots \cap A_{i_k}) = \prod_{j=1}^k P(A_{i_j})$$

- 3 **Comment:** Note that for a sequence of events $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$ it is **not** suffi-
4 cient that

5
$$P(A_1 \cap A_2 \cap \dots \cap A_n) = \prod_{i=1}^n P(A_i)$$

- 6 in order that $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$ be independent.

- 7 But, of course, if $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$ are **assumed** to be independent, then it
8 holds that

9
$$P(A_1 \cap A_2 \cap \dots \cap A_n) = \prod_{i=1}^n P(A_i)$$

- 10 This is the most commonly used application of independent events.

layer: 15sigma22pa

KNOW AND SHOW 5

[CLICK HERE for Know And Show GLOSSARY of TERMS](#)

Category 6: Chances Are

Three out of 45 games that Arlene bowls, she scores a minimum of 280 points. How would you describe her chances that on her next 18 games she will bowl at least one game with a score of 280 points or higher?

Points Earned: 0

click answer

Good	☐
Very Poor	☐
Poor	☐
Very Good	☐

$$A_i = \{ \text{she scores at least 280 in game } i \}$$

$$i = 1, 2, \dots, 18$$

$$P(\text{at least one 280 point game})$$

$$= 1 - P(\text{no 280 point games})$$

$$= 1 - P(A_1^c \cap A_2^c \cap \dots \cap A_{18}^c)$$

$$= 1 - P(A_1^c) P(A_2^c) \dots P(A_{18}^c)$$

Assuming
Events independent

$$= 1 - \left(\frac{14}{15}\right)^{18} = 0.71$$

"very good"

Note: A, B independent $\Rightarrow A^c, B^c$ independent

Rule of Thumb: In a sequence of n independent trials, for which the prob. of "success" is $\frac{1}{n}$ on each, the prob. of at least one success is approx. $\frac{2}{3}$

$$1 - \left(\frac{n-1}{n}\right)^n \approx \frac{2}{3}$$

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} 1 - e^{-1}$$

Exercise (From HOTS): If you like gambling and you like betting on the outcome of sports matches, then you may like the "parlay card." A parlay card lets you bet on the outcomes of more than one match. In order to win a parlay bet, you must be correct on ^{all} each of the matches you bet upon. Parlay cards offer big payoffs if you are right on every match.

Suppose that your bookie will give you 10-to-1 odds for a parlay bet that covers four sports matches. Should you take the bet?

$$\text{"10 to 1 odds"} \Rightarrow P(\text{lose bet}) / P(\text{win bet}) = 10$$

$$\text{Let } p = P(\text{player wins}), \text{ then } \frac{1-p}{p} = 10, \text{ i.e. } p = \frac{1}{11}$$

If I assume the chance of me choosing correctly is $\frac{1}{2}$ on each match, and matches are independent

$$P(\text{player wins}) = \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^4 = \frac{1}{16}$$

So, since $\frac{1}{16} < \frac{1}{11}$, should not take the bet

Conditional Independence

Suppose that events A_1 and A_2 are not necessarily independent, but there is another event B such that

$$P(A_1 \cap A_2 | B) = P(A_1 | B)P(A_2 | B)$$

Then we say that A_1 and A_2 are **independent conditional on B** .

Example: Imagine that there are three coins: One is a regular two-sided coin, another has “Heads” on both sides, and another has “Tails” on both sides. One of three coins is chosen at random, and then flipped twice. Let A_i be the event that flip i comes up “Heads.”

Then, A_1 and A_2 are dependent, but if I define B_j to be the event that the chosen coin has j sides with “Heads,” (with $j = 0, 1, 2$), then A_1 and A_2 are independent conditional on any one of the B_j .

$$A_1 = \{\text{flip 1 heads}\}$$

$$A_2 = \{\text{flip 2 heads}\}$$

$$P(A_2 | A_1) \neq P(A_2)$$

Exercise: A bank classifies customers as either a good or bad credit risk. On the basis of extensive historical data, the bank has observed that 1% of good credit risks and 10% of bad credit risks overdraw their account in any given month. A new customer opens a checking account at the bank. On the basis of a check with the credit bureau, the bank believes that there is a 70% chance that the customer will turn out to be a good credit risk.

Suppose that this customer's account is overdrawn in the first month. How does this alter the bank's opinion of this customer's creditworthiness? What if the customer overdraws the account again in the second month?

$B = \{\text{person is good credit risk}\}$

$A_i = \{\text{person overdraws in month } i\} \quad i=1,2$

$P(B) = 0.70$ "prior prob."

$P(A_i | B) = 0.01 \quad P(A_i | B^c) = 0.10 \quad i=1,2$

In first question, asking for $P(B | A_1)$

Use Bayes Rule, $P(B | A_1) = 0.19$

Now get more "data": Customer overdraws in month 2

Redo Bayes Rule with prior prob. of 0.19, find that prob. of being a good credit risk is 0.02

"Bayesian Updating"

Imagine instead observe "data" after two months. The "data" is $A_1 \cap A_2$, $P(B) = 0.70$

$$P(B | A_1 \cap A_2) = \frac{P(A_1 \cap A_2 | B) P(B)}{P(A_1 \cap A_2 | B) P(B) + P(A_1 \cap A_2 | B^c) P(B^c)}$$

assuming
 A_1, A_2 ind.
cond. on B

$$= \frac{P(A_1 | B) P(A_2 | B) P(B)}{P(A_1 | B) P(A_2 | B) P(B) + P(A_1 | B^c) P(A_2 | B^c) P(B^c)}$$

$$= 0.02$$

Bayesian updating assumes conditional independence of the new information

A_1, A_2 clearly dependent

Are A_1, A_2 conditionally independent on B

Part 2: Random Variables

A **random variable (RV)** is a function that assigns a real value to each outcome $\omega \in \Omega$.

$$X: \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

We almost always use capital letters late in the alphabet such as U , V , X , Y , and Z to denote random variables.

Example: Suppose that X equals the number of tosses of a fair coin in order to see the first “Heads.”

Then, one could write

$$\Omega = \{H, TH, TTH, TTTH, \dots\}$$

and then would define $X: \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ as

$$X(H) = 1$$

$$X(TH) = 2$$

$$X(TTH) = 3$$

$$\vdots$$

1 When we write " $P(X \leq c)$," for instance, it should be understood is that
2 this means

$$\overbrace{P(\{\omega: X(\omega) \leq c\})}^{\subseteq \Omega}.$$

4 When it is written in this way, it is clear that

$$\{\omega: X(\omega) \leq c\}$$

6 is a subset of Ω .

7 **Exercise:** Is it necessarily the case that

$$P(\{\omega: X(\omega) \leq c\})$$

9 is defined?

10 No. In order for it to be defined

11 $\{\omega: X(\omega) \leq c\} \in \mathcal{F}$, the collection

12 of sets for which $P(\cdot)$ is defined

14 If $\{\omega: X(\omega) \leq c\} \in \mathcal{F}$ for all c , then
15 X is measurable

(CDF)

17 The **cumulative distribution function** for a random variable X is

$$F_X(c) = P(X \leq c)$$

Exercise: Two fair coins are tossed and the outcome is observed. Before the coins are tossed, we are given a choice of the following payoffs:

Payoff 1: Win \$1 for each head.

Lose \$3 for getting two tails.

Payoff 2: Win \$1 if the coins are different.

Win \$2 if both coins turn up tails.

Lose \$3 if both coins turn up heads.

Which payoff should we choose? Write the CDFs of the random variables.

$$\Omega = \{HH, HT, TH, TT\} \quad 4 \text{ ELO}$$

$X = \text{payoff under 1}$

$Y = \text{payoff under 2}$

$$X(HH) = 2 \quad Y(HH) = -3$$

$$X(HT) = 1 \quad Y(HT) = 1$$

$$X(TH) = 1 \quad Y(TH) = 1$$

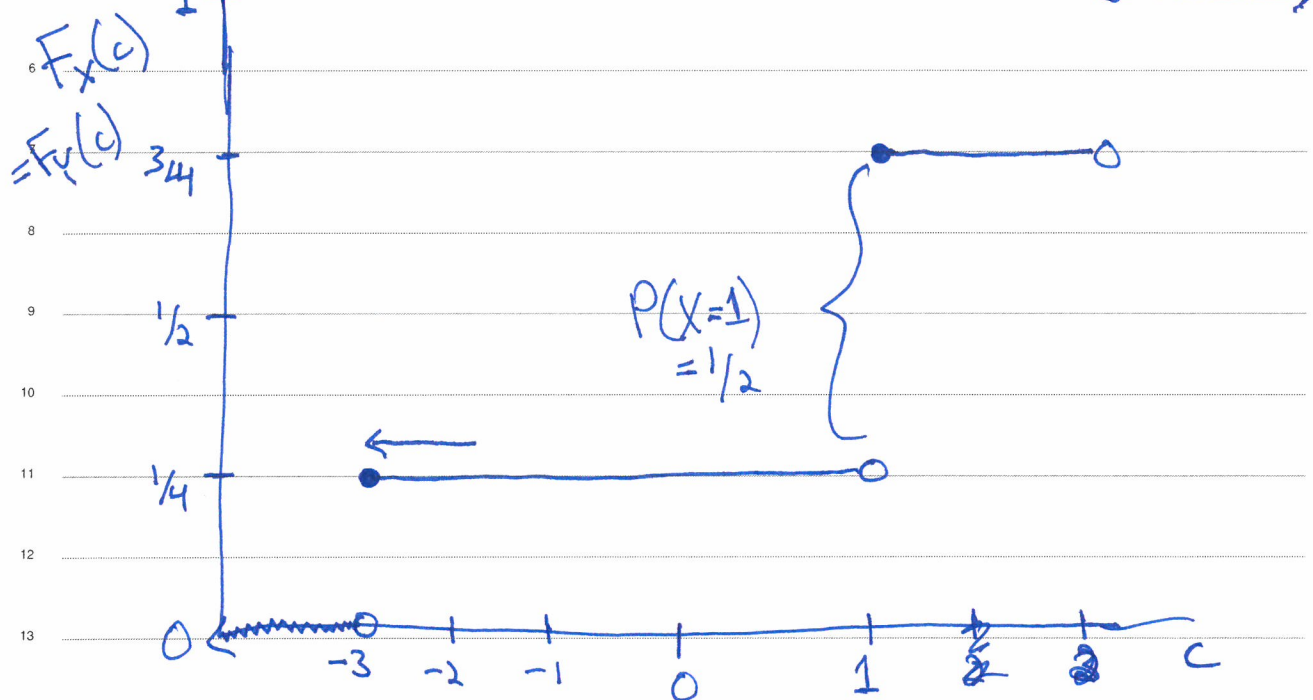
$$X(TT) = -3 \quad Y(TT) = 2$$

Note $X \neq Y$, they are not the same function on Ω

But, X, Y have the same distribution

$$P(X \in A) = P(Y \in A) \quad \text{for any } A \subseteq \mathbb{R}$$

What is their CDF?



1 Properties of any CDF

2 The CDF F_X must satisfy the following properties:

3 1. $F_X(c)$ is nondecreasing as a function of c .

4 2. $\lim_{c \nearrow \infty} F_X(c) = 1$

5 3. $\lim_{c \searrow -\infty} F_X(c) = 0$

6 4. F_X is **right-continuous**, i.e. $\lim_{y \searrow c} F_X(y) = F_X(c)$

7 5. $P(X > c) = 1 - F_X(c)$.

8 6. $P(X = c) = F_X(c) - \lim_{y \nearrow c} F_X(y)$ = size of jump in CDF at c

9 7. $P(a < X \leq b) = F_X(b) - F_X(a)$

10 8. The CDF uniquely determines the distribution. In other words, if two
11 random variables have the same CDF, they have the same distribution.

Points: Have RV X , and derive its CDF
and I find it matches the "known"
CDF of some family (e.g. Exponential),
then can claim X is Exponential

Basics of Discrete Random Variables

Distributions of random variables are divided into three groups: discrete, continuous, and mixed.

Discrete distributions give positive probability to a countable collection of values. Often this collection is a subset of the nonnegative integers, but that is not part of the definition.

A discrete random variable is characterized by its **probability mass function (pmf)**, denoted f_X :

$$f_X(k) = P(X = k)$$

The **expected value** of a discrete random variable is then defined naturally as

$$E(X) = \sum_{k: f_X(k) > 0} k f_X(k)$$

Note that $P(X = E(X))$ is often 0.

- 1 **Exercise (From HOTS):** You and I are to play a game. You roll a die until
2 a number other than a one appears. When such a number appears for the
3 first time, I pay you the same number of dollars as there are dots on the
4 upturned face of the die, and the game ends. What is the expected payoff
5 to this game?

6 $X = \text{value on last roll}$

7
$$P(X=k) = \frac{1}{5}, \quad k=2, 3, \dots, 6$$

9
$$f_X(2) = f_X(3) = \dots = f_X(6) = \frac{1}{5}$$

11
$$E(X) = \sum_{k=2}^6 k f_X(k)$$

13
$$= (2)\left(\frac{1}{5}\right) + (3)\left(\frac{1}{5}\right) + (4)\left(\frac{1}{5}\right) + (5)\left(\frac{1}{5}\right)$$

15
$$+ (6)\left(\frac{1}{5}\right) = 4$$

Exercise: Suppose that random variable X has pmf

$$f_X(k) = \frac{1}{k^s z(s)}, \quad \text{for } k = 1, 2, \dots, \text{ and } s > 1$$

where

$$z(s) = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{i^s} \quad \leftarrow \text{"normalizing constant"}$$

is the **zeta function**. (This is the **Zeta Distribution**.)

What is $E(X)$ in this case?

$$E(X) = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} k \left(\frac{1}{k^s z(s)} \right)$$

$$\text{Recall: } \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{i} = \infty, \quad \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \left(\frac{1}{i} \right)^s < \infty \text{ for } s > 1$$

If $s = 2$

$$E(X) = \frac{1}{z(2)} \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} = \infty$$

In fact when $1 < s \leq 2$, $E(X) = \infty$

If $s > 2$,

$$E(X) = \frac{1}{z(s)} \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^{s-1}} = \frac{z(s-1)}{z(s)} < \infty$$

Note: $E(X) = \infty$ even though $P(X = \infty) = 0$

Exercise: Suppose that random variable X has pmf

$$f_X(k) = \frac{1}{2k^2 z(2)}, \quad k = \pm 1, \pm 2, \dots$$

What is $E(X)$ in this case?

Technical Assumption: In order for $E(X)$ to exist,

$$E(X) = \underbrace{\sum_{\substack{k: \\ k \geq 0, f_X(k) > 0}} k f_X(k)}_{(1)} + \underbrace{\sum_{\substack{k: k < 0 \\ f_X(k) > 0}} k f_X(k)}_{(2)}$$

If (1) is ∞ and (2) is $-\infty$,
then $E(X)$ does not exist

In this example, $E(X)$ does not exist